

→ Conceptual topic sentence focuses on self autonomy attributed to curiosity.

*evidence* → Curiosity is an omnipotent aspect of humanity that enables people to transcend their limits. Weir suggests to the audience that individuals are often controlled by the dominance of media and surveillance. The imprisonment experienced by Truman is symbolised by the fishbowl cameras, which occurs when we see Truman through the buttonholes of other actors. The fishbowl represents how an individual may not realise how limited their environment is, just as a fish does not know anything exists beyond its bowl. However, Weir's choice to allow Truman to escape Seahaven despite his severe entrapment, ultimately conveys how one's curiosity for truth about the world is unbreakable. This is alluded to by the dialogue "you never had a camera inside my head," which conveys how although one physically succumbs to their environment, the physiological need for exploration is inextricable. Thus, through enabling Truman to escape Seahaven, Weir builds his audience's appreciation of the strength of curiosity and pays tribute to our deep-seeded need to explore our natural habitats, both our home and beyond. → *Contextualisation*  
→ *text-level analysis*  
→ *text-level analysis*  
→ *Composer's Intention*  
→ *technique*  
→ *Link*

*cohesive device*

*thesis statement*

Ultimately, Peter Weir expands his audience's appreciation of the individuals engaging with their environment. He achieves this through demonstrating the susceptibility of individuals to their environment and highlighting the fragility of reality. However, he also challenges the prevailing assumption of humanity's vulnerability, through demonstrating the sheer power of curiosity and spirit.

paraphrase of conceptual sentences in body paragraphs

## Contextualisation

The notion of the subjectivity of reality is explored cynically by Weir. The

close-up shot of Christof's face emitting the imperative, "we accept the reality of the world with which we are presented. It's as simple as that." Through this use of

language, Weir powerfully reveals that Truman's acceptance of his world is how any other humans in modern-day society would accept theirs. This expands his audience's appreciation further through promoting the viewer to reflect upon their own engagement with the world around them, and question how real their world really is. Thus, Weir's use of cinematic techniques to portray his characters, enables him to

reflect on the manner that humans in contemporary society succumb to their environment, expanding his audience's understanding of their vulnerability to conformity and ignorance. "The Truman Show," satirises modern society, portraying

dystopian ideas that we are imprisoned by media and advertisement, expanding the audience's awareness of their stance in the world. Truman's world initially appears as

a utopia, emphasised by Seahaven's smiling citizens, the town's pastel colour palette and the use of the diegetic music of Mozart, a composer known for his perfect use of balance. However, this world shifts from utopian to dystopian as the audience realise

that Truman is trapped in an artificial environment created entirely for the economic gain of its producers. The recurring motif of product placement in several scenes in

the film contributes to the monetised reality that the producers have created. For instance, as Truman is walking to work, two men pin him against a poster and a

zoom-in shot reveals it is for "Kaiser's Free-Range Chicken", facing the audience, Truman has his back forcibly shoved into the advertising billboard to gain the perfect

shot of the product. The use of a zoom-in technique conveys the idea that the audience are the ones being manipulated by mass media and consumerism, more than Truman himself. This prompts the audience to question their individual

autonomy, and the extent to which an individual controls how they interact with their environment in modern day society, alluding to the dominance of advertising and

media. The audience is confronted with the fearful notion that we are possibly as entrapped as Truman.

technique

evidence

text level analysis

audience-level analysis

link

conceptual sentence focuses on the imprisonment caused by the media and ads

text level analysis

text-level analysis

audience level analysis

link

Cohesive device

Contextualisation

technique

evidence

technique

evidence

technique

evidence

technique

evidence

Cause/Effect structure

"Literature reveals individuals engaging with their environment." Discuss this statement with close reference to your prescribed text.

Clear thesis statement

Text introduction that clearly lays out 3 thematic focuses that relate to the question

Films have the unique ability to profoundly expand our appreciation of individuals

engaging with their environment. Peter Weir's 1998 satirical film, "The Truman Show,"

has distinctive qualities that convey ideas about one's perception of reality, media,

and individual autonomy. Weir's construction of scenes and use of cinematic

techniques portray settings and situations of contemporary society that reciprocate

ideas of environmental entrapment, creating a cautionary tale. Through his masterful

characterisation of Truman Burbank, Weir extends his audience's appreciation of how

individuals interact with their environments and their perception of reality. Hence,

Weir communicates the susceptibility of individuals to their surrounding environment,

expanding his audience's self-awareness and prompting them to question their own

reality.

Conceptual topic sentence focuses on one theme - impact of portrayal of people on perception of reality

Great filmmakers truthfully portray people to broaden our understanding of the

fragility of reality. Weir's creation of Truman as blissful and well-mannered allows his

character to represent the kind-hearted every man living a normal, modern-day life.

Truman's comical dialogue to his fellow neighbours, "Good morning, and in case I

don't see ya, good afternoon, good evening and goodnight" conveys his level of

belonging within his environment. The employment of colloquial terms such as 'ya'

instead of 'you' represent Truman's laid-back, personable nature that may resonate

with the audience. Additionally, Truman undergoes everyday chores and habits, as

seen in the extreme long-shot of him mowing the lawn, which emphasises his

acceptance of the artificial environment he inhabits and symbolises his lack of power.

Through Weir's portrayal of Truman being a standard citizen, he can effectively hint to

the audience that Truman is in fact resembling all humans of our contemporary

society. Essentially, Weir expands his audience's appreciation of how individuals

engage with their environment through revealing one's ignorance of reality and by

making Truman a relatable symbol of every human.

leading sentences expand on the thesis in respect to environment, characterisation and intended impact on audiences.

elaboration / contextualisation

evidence

text-level analysis

evidence

text-level + audience-level analysis.

text-level analysis

text-level analysis

text-level analysis

audience-level analysis / composer's intended impact on audience

audience-level analysis / composer's intended impact on audience

audience-level analysis / composer's intended impact on audience

audience-level analysis / composer's intended impact on audience

Link

**Mood:** The feeling the audience experiences:

| <b>Mood adjective</b> | <b>Simple definition</b>                                      |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Happy                 | Feeling joyful or pleased.                                    |
| Sad                   | Feeling unhappy or sorrowful.                                 |
| Excited               | Feeling eager and full of energy.                             |
| Calm                  | Feeling peaceful and relaxed.                                 |
| Relaxed               | Free from stress or worry.                                    |
| Cheerful              | Feeling happy and positive.                                   |
| Gloomy                | Feeling dark, sad, or depressing.                             |
| Hopeful               | Feeling positive about the future.                            |
| Fearful               | Feeling afraid or worried.                                    |
| Tense                 | Feeling stressed or uneasy.                                   |
| Nervous               | Feeling anxious or worried.                                   |
| Peaceful              | Feeling quiet and calm.                                       |
| Lonely                | Feeling alone or isolated.                                    |
| Confused              | Feeling unsure or unable to understand clearly.               |
| Curious               | Feeling interested and wanting to know more.                  |
| Inspired              | Feeling motivated or encouraged.                              |
| Nostalgic             | Missing or remembering the past fondly.                       |
| Romantic              | Feeling connected to love or affection.                       |
| Suspenseful           | Feeling excited and uncertain about what will happen next.    |
| Mysterious            | Feeling that something is unknown or hard to explain.         |
| Playful               | Feeling fun and light-hearted.                                |
| Energetic             | Feeling active and full of energy.                            |
| Content               | Feeling satisfied and at ease.                                |
| Melancholy            | Feeling gently sad or thoughtful.                             |
| Dreamy                | Feeling imaginative or lost in thought.                       |
| Cozy                  | Feeling warm, comfortable, and safe.                          |
| Uneasy                | Feeling uncomfortable or worried.                             |
| Overwhelmed           | Feeling burdened by too much happening at once.               |
| Triumphant            | Feeling successful or victorious.                             |
| Awkward               | Feeling uncomfortable or embarrassed.                         |
| Hopeful               | Feeling that good things may happen.                          |
| Despairing            | Feeling that there is no hope.                                |
| Joyful                | Feeling great happiness.                                      |
| Reflective            | Feeling thoughtful and thoughtful about experiences or ideas. |
| Uplifting             | Creating feelings of hope and happiness.                      |

| Mood adjective | Simple definition                            |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Sombre         | Feeling serious, sad, or thoughtful.         |
| Chaotic        | Feeling disorderly, busy, or confusing.      |
| Comforting     | Creating feelings of reassurance and safety. |
| Eerie          | Feeling strange, spooky, or unsettling.      |
| Furious        | Feeling extremely angry.                     |

### Most used adjectives to describe background music:

| Adjective   | Simple definition                                    |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Calm        | Quiet and relaxing.                                  |
| Soft        | Gentle and not loud.                                 |
| Soothing    | Helping people feel relaxed or comforted.            |
| Relaxing    | Making people feel calm and less stressed.           |
| Gentle      | Mild and peaceful in sound.                          |
| Peaceful    | Creating a quiet and calm feeling.                   |
| Upbeat      | Lively, positive, and energetic.                     |
| Cheerful    | Happy and pleasant sounding.                         |
| Energetic   | Full of energy and activity.                         |
| Lively      | Bright, active, and exciting.                        |
| Dramatic    | Creating strong emotions or excitement.              |
| Emotional   | Expressing strong feelings.                          |
| Melancholic | Slightly sad or thoughtful.                          |
| Sad         | Creating feelings of sadness.                        |
| Happy       | Creating feelings of joy or pleasure.                |
| Mysterious  | Creating curiosity or a sense of the unknown.        |
| Suspenseful | Building tension or anticipation.                    |
| Inspiring   | Encouraging positive feelings or motivation.         |
| Romantic    | Creating feelings of love or affection.              |
| Dreamy      | Soft and imaginative, like a dream.                  |
| Atmospheric | Helping create a particular feeling or setting.      |
| Ambient     | Designed to create mood without demanding attention. |
| Smooth      | Flowing pleasantly without harsh sounds.             |
| Jazzy       | Having a style or feeling similar to jazz music.     |
| Rhythmic    | Having a strong, regular beat.                       |
| Catchy      | Easy to remember and enjoyable to listen to.         |
| Modern      | Having a current or contemporary style.              |
| Classical   | Having a traditional or orchestral style.            |
| Elegant     | Refined and graceful sounding.                       |
| Powerful    | Strong and impressive in sound.                      |

### Common examples

- **Coffee shop music:** calm, soft, relaxing, ambient
- **Study music:** soothing, gentle, peaceful, atmospheric
- **Workout music:** upbeat, energetic, lively
- **Movie soundtrack music:** dramatic, emotional, suspenseful, inspiring

**Tone:** The writer's or speaker's attitude

| <b>Tone adjective</b> | <b>Simple definition</b>                                     |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Amused                | Finding something funny or entertaining.                     |
| Angry                 | Showing strong displeasure or annoyance.                     |
| Anxious               | Showing worry or nervousness.                                |
| Apologetic            | Expressing regret or saying sorry.                           |
| Bitter                | Showing resentment or hurt feelings.                         |
| Calm                  | Showing peace and self-control.                              |
| Caring                | Showing kindness and concern for others.                     |
| Cheerful              | Showing happiness and positivity.                            |
| Confident             | Showing belief in oneself or one's ideas.                    |
| Critical              | Expressing disapproval or pointing out faults.               |
| Curious               | Showing a desire to know more.                               |
| Defensive             | Trying to protect oneself from criticism.                    |
| Encouraging           | Giving support or confidence.                                |
| Enthusiastic          | Showing excitement and strong interest.                      |
| Formal                | Using serious and proper language.                           |
| Friendly              | Showing warmth and kindness.                                 |
| Frustrated            | Showing irritation because something is difficult or unfair. |
| Humorous              | Intended to be funny or amusing.                             |
| Hopeful               | Showing optimism about the future.                           |
| Informal              | Casual and relaxed in style.                                 |
| Inspirational         | Motivating others to act or feel positive.                   |
| Joyful                | Expressing great happiness.                                  |
| Loving                | Showing affection and care.                                  |
| Nervous               | Showing fear or worry.                                       |
| Optimistic            | Expecting good things to happen.                             |
| Passionate            | Showing strong feelings or enthusiasm.                       |
| Pessimistic           | Expecting bad things to happen.                              |
| Playful               | Light-hearted and fun.                                       |
| Proud                 | Showing satisfaction in achievements.                        |
| Respectful            | Showing politeness and admiration.                           |
| Sad                   | Expressing unhappiness or sorrow.                            |
| Sarcastic             | Using irony to mock or make a point.                         |
| Serious               | Thoughtful and not joking.                                   |
| Sincere               | Honest and genuine.                                          |
| Sympathetic           | Showing understanding and compassion.                        |

| <b>Tone adjective</b> | <b>Simple definition</b>                          |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Tense                 | Showing stress or pressure.                       |
| Urgent                | Showing that something needs immediate attention. |
| Warm                  | Showing friendliness and affection.               |

## Community

### Extract 1: Stuart's Mum

Stuart's mum did not say anything else but she stayed near him, and Mrs Martin came over and started counting the money on the counter.

'I'll get two twenty cent bags of mixed lollies as well,' Harry said, and he smiled at Stuart. Stuart smiled back.

The girl was still there by the bus shelter when they left the shop. She was smoking a cigarette now, still looking down the road. She had definitely missed the bus. As they drove off in the car, Harry turned and looked through the back window. The girl chucked her cigarette on the gravel and kicked at it with her foot. Then she kicked the bus shelter. She was stuck here too.

'You can drop me off near the bridge.'

It would save him having to walk all the way to George's from home, only he regretted saying anything now. He could see Stuart's mum's eyes in the rear vision mirror and she looked worried, like she was about to ask a question.

'Aren't you coming back to ours?' Stuart said.

Harry shrugged. He felt bad. Stuart was nice and staying there was good except that they had to sleep in the annex of the caravan and the air was a bit cold on your face. But Stuart's mum always put hot water bottles in their beds so that the sheets and doona were already warm when you got in. So warm you could not help but go straight to sleep, even if you did not want to, even if you wanted to stay up talking.

Harry put his hand in his pocket, felt for his dart gun and pulled it out.

'You can take this. You can keep it till I come and stay again.'

Stuart took the orange plastic gun in his hands.

'When?'

'Maybe tomorrow, or the next day? Don't lose the darts.'

Stuart nodded. He took the darts from Harry's hand and put them in his pocket. Harry knew Stuart would lose at least one.

Near the bridge the car pulled over. Stuart's mum turned. She looked right at Harry, held onto the seat with her arm.

'Maybe you should come home with us, sweetie. I'll make some lunch later.'

'There's food at home. Dad will have left something out. Thanks for having me, Mrs Phillips.'

Her eyes were big, but she did not say anything else.

Harry got out of the car and shut the door. He waved to Stuart and Stuart waved back. And Harry kept waving, hoping the car would drive away. But it did not. Stuart's mum was taking ages. She was worrying, having one of her moments where nothing happened and she just went still for a bit. Went quiet. Dad said she was cracked, but Harry thought she was nice. She was just nice.

Finally the car pulled off. Slowly. Stuart turned in his seat and pulled a funny face and waved again with the dart gun firmly in his hand. Harry coughed in the dust and waved one last time. When they were gone, he ran down the road to the path that led to George's, clutching the tea.

## **Extract 2: Mr. Roberts**

'Jesus! Are you all right?'

Mr Roberts was out of the car. He had come round and was standing on the side of the road. Miles could not speak. He wiped his mouth and sat back in his seat. He did not want to look at Mr Roberts, and he tried not to look outside at all, but his eyes kept finding that tree, kept staring at the tree and at the lilies until he knew that they were real. That the flowers were really there.

Like they had been after she died. For months and months. Fresh lilies on the tree.

Mr Roberts took his time getting back in the car and when he did he did not start the engine.

'Butter Menthol went down the wrong way,' Miles said.

Mr Roberts did not say anything. Not for a bit. He handed Miles a hankie.

'I never pass here without thinking of her, you know. Not without thinking of your mum. It must have been bloody terrible.'

Miles blew his nose on the hankie. He shut his eyes.

'I don't really remember,' he said.

When he opened his eyes, Miles looked at the tree again. It still had a scar, a line where the bark had never grown back. And it was amazing that it had survived at all. They had hit it so hard.

When they pulled up the drive Miles opened the passenger door. He went to get out but Mr Roberts put his hand on his shoulder and held him back.

'Don't you get stuck here with your dad,' he said.

'Don't you let him ... You're too young to be out there working, Miles. It's not right.'

Miles felt the words sink right down inside him.

'You've had it rough enough,' he said.

And he let Miles go.

## Grief and loss

### Extract 3: Miles imagines mum

So he lay on the front of that big board. Held on while the white water splashed up in his face, freezing, and he could see nothing but Nick's arms reaching out to scoop through the water again and again. He felt the board move up and over, up and over until they were out deep. Until they were out on the clear.

Nick helped him sit upright and tall on the nose of the board, and with his legs hanging over the sides he was brave. He looked down into the water. All the way to the bottom.

Ripples in the soft sand. Balls of loose seaweed flying free and weightless. The black rock and reef hiding thin beneath the sand.

'Safe here,' he said, Uncle Nick.

And when Miles looked up there was a line of water, long and straight and rolling. And it was coming.

Everything was silent then. There was only feeling. Rolling, rolling; and silent.

The pulse. It lifted them up gentle and slow. Lifted them high so they could see.

Then it let them loose. Left them behind. And time came back.

Miles turned his face towards the beach, followed the line with his eyes. He watched it rise up. Watched it crack and peel, perfect, to the shore.

And he saw Mum standing there on the sand all golden in the sun.

He waved to her.

And she waved back.

### Extract 4: Dad's abuse is underpinned by the loss of his wife

Miles saw Harry's arm reach out of the water. He saw his face there in the churning mess. The current had him now, his mouth open, his arms flailing. He was moving away, moving into the channel.

'You remember,' Dad said, and he held Miles tight. 'You remember, don't you?'

And he kept shaking Miles, kept pulling his face away from the water, away from Harry.

'They were dead when I found the car.'

And the insides of Miles went very still. He couldn't see Harry now. He couldn't see him

anywhere. There was only water. Only all that water moving.

'She was leaving me.'

Dad pulled Miles in close, so close that his face was all Miles could see. And it made him sick the way Dad's face was. The way he looked like he was crying. Like someone had done something terrible to him.

'I had to take him away, Miles. I had to leave you there. He was already dead and everyone would have found out. Everyone would have known.'

With everything he had left in him, Miles pushed. He pushed out his arms, braced his body back against the rail. And he screamed for Harry. He screamed his name out over and over. And he felt Dad move, felt his grip loosen.

'You're my son,' he said.

Then he let Miles go.

Miles took a step, grabbed onto the rail, and he looked back at Dad standing still with his eyes closed, his arms loose by his sides. Then he leapt into the water. He bombed down.

## Isolation

### hExtract 5: Miles' isolation on the boat

The moon was out, a tiny slither, and some of the brighter stars were still shining, but they were becoming translucent and starting to hide. It would be light soon.

And once the sun cracked orange, it came up quick.

It changed everything.

When Miles looked at the horizon he saw three shapes in the distance. They were heading out to the old islands. The Last Islands.

Black in outline, black in shape.

Black Witch, Flat Witch, Temple Rocks.

Rocks that stood alone in the middle of nothing, in the middle of endless ocean. Miles had never been this far out.

Beyond here, what? Only a few clustered specks of black on the map where no one ever lived and where no one ever went.

Maatsuyker was the last island to reach out of the darkness.

The end of the earth.

Out here the pulse could get bigger than ten metres and the islands were marked and scarred. Battered cliffs, broken rocky beaches, caves worn well into the rock. It was like another world, roaring and squalling with life. Cliffs screaming with birds, with shearwaters and silver gulls, oystercatchers and storm-petrels. Patches of scrub and green clinging to any flat surface. And

the water was really moving, deep channels carved between the islands. Silent currents.

#### **Extract 6: Dad abuses Harry on the boat before throwing him overboard**

He was on the radio. And his voice got louder and then he started to scream as Dad smashed into the cabin. Miles heard the radio receiver hit the ground before he could even move. Dad had Harry by the shoulders and he shook him like a rag doll. He dragged him out onto the deck.

'These are protected waters, you idiot! You always fuck everything up. You always fuck everything!'

And he slammed Harry against the rails. Held him there, and the spray was coming over thick now, soaking Harry, drenching his hair and running down his face. And Harry was squirming and moving and trying to get his body away from the edge until Dad pulled his hair so tight that he stopped.

Harry just closed his eyes then. He just shut his eyes.

And suddenly Jeff spluttered and coughed, and when Miles looked down he was on his side curled up, and he coughed again. He wasn't dead. But Dad didn't notice. He didn't even look. His eyes were fixed on Harry. He just kept staring at Harry. And his hand moved away from Harry's hair, moved down to the string around his neck. And he cupped it in his palm - the white pointer's tooth.

'It's his,' he said, and his face went pale. 'His.' He let the tooth go. He stared down at Harry.

'She was leaving, because of him. Because of you.' And that's when it happened. When something inside of Harry must have just gone wrong. Because he opened his eyes and he looked right at Dad and he said, 'I'm glad.'

And all of it came at once then.

Miles saw the wave; he saw Dad push Harry. And he went to run but something caught his leg, pulled him down. It was Jeff. Blood drained from his face.

#### **Extract 7: Miles protects Harry after being thrown overboard**

The wind stung his face, his wet head. He knew the more you moved your limbs around, the more heat you lost. Blood moved to the surface where its warmth was stolen by the water. The key was keeping still.

Slowing down. Trying not to fall asleep.

'I'm scared,' Harry said.

Miles didn't want Harry to know that he was scared, too.

'We just have to wait, Harry. We're OK.'

'What about sharks?'

Miles could hear the fear in Harry's voice. The tears.

'No sharks, Harry.'

It was exhausting to speak and hard to hear in the wind.

Miles had to yell so that Harry could understand. He checked his own hands. Cut and scraped. Not blue, yet, but the water had started to feel warm against his skin.

Harry's crying eventually calmed, but Miles could feel his brother shiver. It was getting worse - rocking through his little frame like it was trying to keep his engine going.

'Harry? OK?'

'Is D-Dad.. c-com-m-ing?' Harry's teeth were chattering like crazy.

'You got your jumper on, Harry?' Silence.

'Harry?'

'Ti-ti-ger ... win-ch-cheater.'

Miles swallowed hard. He'd told Harry to put on his woollen jumper. He'd left one out for him.

He should have checked. He should have made sure.

'D-d-dad ... c-c-om.. ' Harry could barely get the words out now.

No mate, Miles thought. No one's coming.

Miles wished he could see Harry properly, but knew he was better off on his back. Wrapped around. That way Miles could shelter Harry's head from the wind. If he took his jumper off and put it on Harry, it wouldn't make any difference. The heat trapped by the wool would be lost as soon as he peeled it away from his own skin.

'We'll be all right,' he said, and he closed his eyes.

He didn't know what to do.

There was a black emptiness inside him and it was all that he could see. He tried to imagine a fire in the darkness, and at first it was just one blue flame too small to feel. But he willed it on, felt the first flicker of warmth as it grew. Then it raged, turned into a ball of fire, orange and red and hungry. It devoured his stomach, moved up to his lungs, his back. Moved into his heart. He shared it with Harry through his skin.

### How does *Past the Shallows* explore different human experiences?

| Technique                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Evidence                                                                                                                   | Verb         | Analysis (in the text)                                                                                                                  | Verb         | Analysis (big picture link)                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| epigraph                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | "Separated as it were from the rest of the universe"                                                                       | establishes  | the key themes of the text such as isolation, mirroring the character's own feeling of physical and emotional distance from each other. | emphasises   | how humans can feel both physically and emotionally isolated.    |
| <b>Form the analytical sentence:</b> The epigraph at the start of the novel that states "separated as it were from the rest of the universe" establishes the key themes of the text such as isolation, mirroring the character's own feeling of physical and emotional distance from each other. For the reader, this emphasises how humans can feel both physically and emotionally isolated, even from those they are typically meant to be close to, particularly after tragedy. |                                                                                                                            |              |                                                                                                                                         |              |                                                                  |
| The repetition of                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | "Always" as Harry's fear of the ocean is described                                                                         | foreshadows  | Harry's eventual drowning                                                                                                               | highlights   | how fear can be an overwhelming experience that feels relentless |
| <b>Form the analytical sentence:</b> The repetition of "always" as Harry's fear of the ocean is described foreshadows his eventual drowning as well as highlighting how fear can be an overwhelming experience that feels relentless. This challenges the audience to consider their own fears and whether or not these are barriers to change.                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                            |              |                                                                                                                                         |              |                                                                  |
| The longing tone in                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | "Miles wanted to tell Joe that things were bad at home. He wanted to tell him that working on the boat was bad and that he | Demonstrates | Miles' support, sacrifice and love for Joe                                                                                              | re-enforcing | how ultimately, human beings want the best for their families.   |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                     |            |                                                                        |               |                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | didn't know what to do" juxtaposed with "But he didn't say any of that"                                                                             |            |                                                                        |               |                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Form the analytical sentence:</b> The longing tone in "Miles wanted to tell Joe that things were bad at home. He wanted to tell him that working on the boat was bad and that he didn't know what to do" juxtaposed with "But he didn't say any of that" demonstrates Miles' support, sacrifice and love for Joe re-enforcing how ultimately, human beings want the best for their families. Parrett encourages her readers to consider what they would do for their own families and the sacrifices we make to see them succeed. |                                                                                                                                                     |            |                                                                        |               |                                                                                                                              |
| The metaphor of                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | "The tree... still had a scar, a line where the bark had never grown back. And it was amazing that it had survived at all. They had hit it so hard" | represents | Not only the long term scars of grief but also the resilience of Miles | expressing    | How human beings have the power to overcome challenges, however, sometimes their means of doing this is by ignoring reality. |
| <b>Form the analytical sentence:</b> The metaphor of "The tree... still had a scar, a line where the bark had never grown back" represents the long term scars of grief, however, this is contrasted with the positive connotation of "and it was amazing that it had survived at all", symbolising Miles' resilience. This expresses how human beings have the power to overcome challenges, however, sometimes their means of doing this is by ignoring reality.                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                     |            |                                                                        |               |                                                                                                                              |
| The motif and repetition of the word                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | "stuck" as in "Don't you get stuck here with your dad"                                                                                              | emphasises | Miles' fear of being stuck in the same cycle as his father             | demonstrating | Human's desire to move away from things that trap or confine them in order to find a better life.                            |
| <b>Form the analytical sentence:</b> The motif and repetition of the word "stuck" as in "Don't you get stuck here with your dad" emphasises Miles' fear of being stuck in the same cycle as his father demonstrating human's desire to move away from things that trap or confine them in order to find a better life. This positions the audience to question the things that confine them and the                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                     |            |                                                                        |               |                                                                                                                              |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                             |              |                                                              |               |                                                                                                            |
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| barriers they have to overcome in order to feel free.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                             |              |                                                              |               |                                                                                                            |
| The tender imagery of                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | "Dad even brushed Harry's hair back then to stop it getting knotted"        | reveals      | that Dad once had a side to him that cared for Harry         | highlighting  | the power of trauma and grief and the influence it has over people.                                        |
| <b>Form the analytical sentence:</b> The tender imagery of "Dad even brushed Harry's hair back then to stop it getting knotted" reveals that Dad once had a side to him that cared for Harry highlighting the power of trauma and grief and the influence it has over people. This challenges the reader to question the ways in which people's behaviour can change, based on their experiences.                    |                                                                             |              |                                                              |               |                                                                                                            |
| The imagery of                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | "Out past the shallows,... comes the dark water-black and cold and roaring" | reflects     | the importance of the isolated Tasmanian setting in the text | foreshadowing | the feelings of loneliness and isolation experienced consistently throughout the novel.                    |
| <b>Form the analytical sentence:</b> The imagery of "Out past the shallows... comes the dark water-black and cold and roaring" reflects the importance of the isolated Tasmanian setting in the text foreshadowing the feelings of loneliness and isolation experienced consistently throughout the novel. This positions the reader to consider their own environments and how they feel in these spaces.           |                                                                             |              |                                                              |               |                                                                                                            |
| The motif of the                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | "Milo" as in "He wanted to make Miles the best cup of hot Milo ever"        | symbolises   | the love between Harry and Miles                             | demonstrating | the bonds of brotherhood and the resilience that can be formed when humans have someone else to depend on. |
| <b>Form the analytical sentence:</b> The motif of the "Milo" as in "He wanted to make Miles the best cup of hot Milo ever" symbolises the love between Harry and Miles, demonstrating the bonds of brotherhood and the resilience that can be formed when humans have someone else to depend on. Parrett positions the reader to reflect on their own relationships and the strength that can be derived from these. |                                                                             |              |                                                              |               |                                                                                                            |
| Harry's natural,                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                             | demonstrates | Not only the                                                 | This elicits  | a sense of warmth                                                                                          |

|                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
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| <p>short dialogue “I’ll get two twenty cent bags of mixed lollies as well.” together with the <b>mirrored action</b> between the two boys: “he smiled at Stuart. Stuart smiled back.”</p> |  |  | <p>friendship and close bond between the boys, but also how kind and generous Harry is. Despite the fact that Harry doesn’t have much money, he is willing to share the best he can afford with his friend. As Stuart “smiled back”, it indicates the tacit understanding between the two friends that one “bag of the cady” is for him.</p> |  | <p>and intimacy among the readers, making them appreciate the little but heartwarming moments with their friends, also realizing generosity is not measured by the sheer volume you give; it’s about giving your best within your capacity.</p> |
| Form the analytical sentence:                                                                                                                                                             |  |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

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| <p>The poor condition of Stuart’s place, “they had to sleep in the annex of the caravan and the air was a bit cold on your face.” <b>juxtaposed</b> with the <b>high modality</b> of “But Stuart’s mum always put hot water bottles in</p> |  | <p><b>Symbolises</b></p> | <p>Stuart’s mother’s extended maternal inclusion and hospitality towards Harry</p> | <p>Which is very heartening for the audience</p> | <p>To see a maternal figure in Harry’s life as he lost his mother at such a young age.</p> |
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| their beds"                   |  |  |  |  |  |
| Form the analytical sentence: |  |  |  |  |  |

|                                                                                                                        |  |           |                                              |                     |                                                                                                                                                              |
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| <p>The “ <b>dart gun</b>” Harry allows Stuard to “keep till I come and stay again” is a <b>token of friendship</b></p> |  | Cementing | Connection and boyhood ties in the community | Making the audience | Reminisce the old days when their friends shared toys with them and how valued and trusted they felt through the little gestures of generosity and kindness. |
| Form the analytical sentence:                                                                                          |  |           |                                              |                     |                                                                                                                                                              |

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| <p><b>The considerate silence and pacing of</b> Mr. Robert ‘s “did not say anything. Not for a bit.” followed by the <b>gesture</b> of “<b>handed Miles a hankie</b>” as a <b>token of practical care</b></p> | Conveys | Not only comfort and neighbourly support for Miles at the vulnerable moment of confronting his mum’s death, but also reveals emotional gravity of a sensible adult being patient and present for a little boy and grieving with him. |  | This positions the audience to realise | Shared grief binds people together and wider community care can help heal wounds that a single family cannot heal alone. |
| Form the analytical sentence:                                                                                                                                                                                 |         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |                                        |                                                                                                                          |

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| In a concerning tone with uncompromising high modality, Mr. Robert asserts: "Don't you let him ... You're too young to be out there working, Miles. It's not right." | Shows | His interpersonal care and adult guardianship towards Miles through verbal intervention and protest against the unfair treatment Miles receives from his absentee dad. |  | This offers the audience false hope that | A watchful, caring community might make a critical difference—early intervention, neighbourly awareness, and support may help prevent tragedies that might otherwise unfold within families. |
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Form the analytical sentence:

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                  |                                                                                                |  |                      |                                      |
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| When Miles sees mum in his imagination, through vivid visual imagery of "he saw Mum standing there on the sand all golden in the sun" followed by the final exchange of warmth "He waved to her. And she waved back." | Skillfully shows | Miles is grieving the loss of his beloved mother, who symbolizes love, security and belonging. |  | Leaving the audience | with a sense of peace and happiness. |
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Form the analytical sentence:

|                                       |         |                                     |  |                         |                                  |
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| Dad's possessive declaration, "You're | reveals | his possessiveness and desperation. |  | This alert the audience | That unresolved trauma and grief |
|---------------------------------------|---------|-------------------------------------|--|-------------------------|----------------------------------|

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| <p>my son," after his repetitive physical abuse of "kept shaking Miles, kept pulling his face away from the water, away from Harry."</p> |  | <p>The short but forceful sentence suggests that he views Miles as the last remaining connection to his broken family. However, instead of expressing love in a healthy way, he uses physical abuse and intimidation, demonstrating how his grief has become abusive.</p> |  |  | <p>can lead to destructive and abusive behaviour toward loved ones.</p> |
| Form the analytical sentence:                                                                                                            |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |  |                                                                         |
|                                                                                                                                          |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |  |                                                                         |

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| <p>The dialogue exposes the source of Dad's trauma. His repeated statements, "They were dead when I found the car" and "She was leaving me"</p> | <p>indicates that</p> | <p>He is haunted by the deaths of his wife and consumed by feelings of abandonment and betrayal. The short, fragmented sentences reflect his emotional instability and suggest he is reliving the traumatic event.</p> |  | <p>This positions the audience to realise</p> | <p>Unresolved trauma can resurface in damaging ways, causing individuals to project their pain onto family members and loved ones and harming them.</p> |
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|  |  | Rather than protecting Miles, Dad forces him to listen to these painful confessions during a life-threatening situation, demonstrating emotional abuse. |  |  |  |
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**Form the analytical sentence:**

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| <p><b>The simile</b> from Miles' observation that Dad "looked like he was crying. Like someone had done something terrible to him."</p> | Shows | <p>Dad sees himself as the victim, despite his harmful actions. His grief over his wife's betrayal blinds him to the suffering he is causing Miles. The irony here is that while Dad believes he has been wronged, he is actively traumatising his son.</p> |  | <p>This reveals to the audience that</p> | <p>unresolved trauma can distort relationships turning parental protection into abuse.</p> |
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**Form the analytical sentence:**

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| <p><b>The symbolism of</b> the treacherous water reinforces Dad's emotional turmoil. As Dad confesses, Miles can see "only water. Only all that water is moving."</p> |  | <p><b>The pathetic fallacy of</b> using an overwhelming image of water mirrors the flood of emotions and memories consuming both characters. It also symbolises how Dad's trauma threatens to drown Miles, both literally and emotionally.</p> |  |  |  |
| Form the analytical sentence:                                                                                                                                         |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |  |  |

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| Form the analytical sentence: |  |  |  |  |  |

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| <p><b>The visual imagery coupled with personification of</b> "Rocks that stood alone in the middle of nothing, in the middle of endless ocean. "</p> | Creates | <p>an image of complete physical isolation. With the <b>repetitive/ anaphoric phrase</b> "in the middle of nothing, in the middle of endless ocean." suggesting emptiness and lack of human presence,</p> |  | <p>Weir expertly elicits</p> | <p>a sense of vulnerability and isolation among the audience as they feel overwhelmed by the vastness of the environment and extreme remoteness of the setting.</p> |
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|  |  | it mirrors Miles' loneliness as he is both physically and emotionally isolated. |  |  |  |
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| <b>The anaphoric phrase</b> "where no one ever lived and where no one ever went" | reinforces the idea that | These places are abandoned, untouched, and disconnected from human society. |  |  |  |
| <b>Form the analytical sentence:</b>                                             |                          |                                                                             |  |  |  |

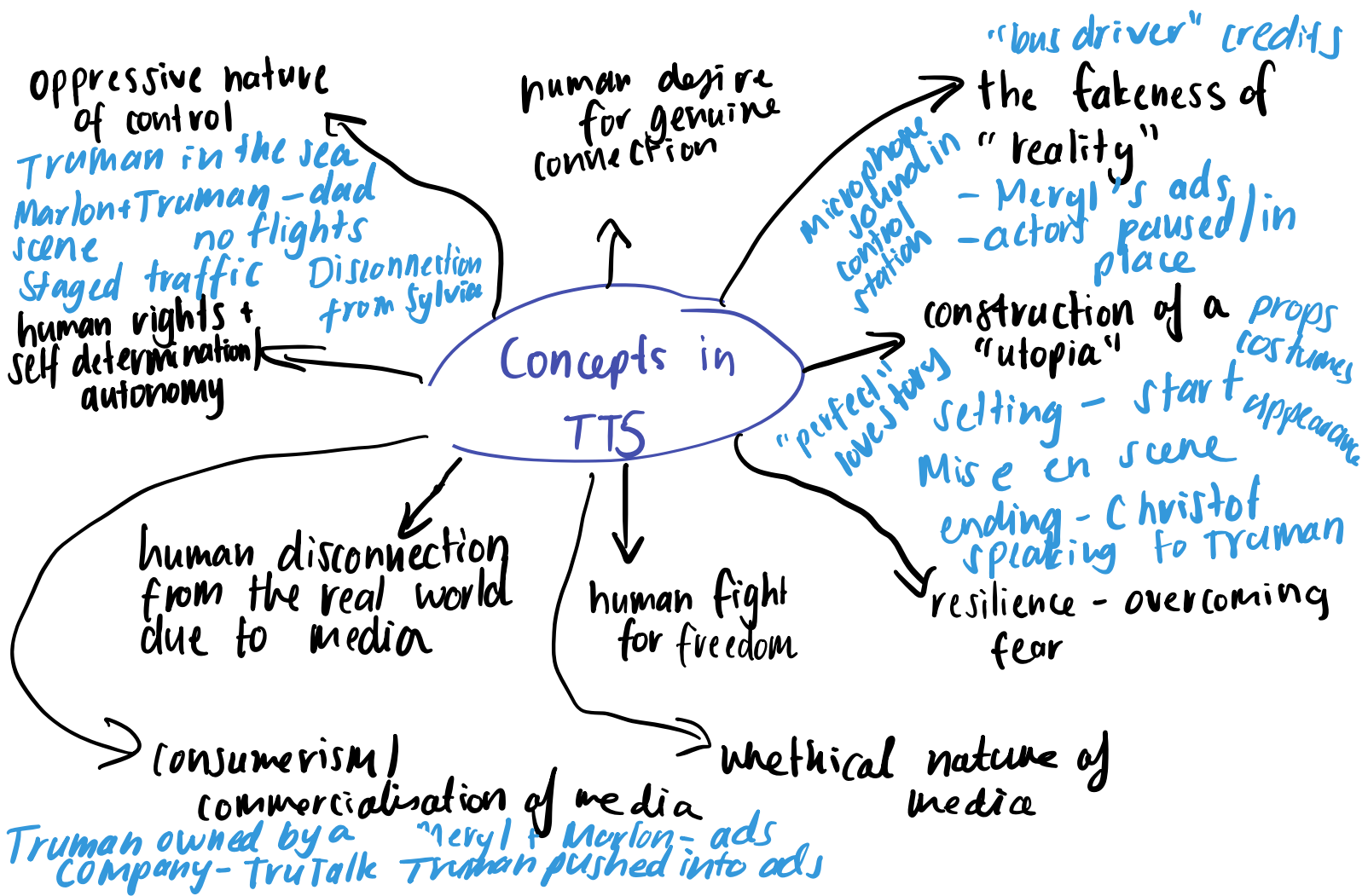
|                                                                                                                             |            |                                                                                                                                                     |  |                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
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| <b>The high modality</b> in "Miles had never been this far out" together with the rhetorical question: "Beyond here, what?" | highlights | Miles' unfamiliarity with the location and suggests that he is beyond the boundaries of comfort and connection, increasing the sense of being alone |  | This is conducive to the audience's understanding | Of the value of social interactions and community support, as they offer a strong sense of belonging and comfort. When they disappear, humans will experience a fading sense of self and extreme vulnerability. |
| <b>Form the analytical sentence:</b>                                                                                        |            |                                                                                                                                                     |  |                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

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| <p><b>The violent imagery with a simile</b> “Dad had Harry by the shoulders and he shook him like a rag doll.”</p>                   | Emphasises   | <p>Dad’s physical dominance, and implies that Harry is dehumanised “like a rag doll”, highlighting the trauma has transformed the father to someone who treats Harry like an object rather than a person.</p>                                                                                                             |  | <p>This warns the audience of</p>         | <p>The danger of not being able to process trauma healthily, resulting in physical violence, emotional intimidation, and an obsessive need to punish someone for their suffering.</p> |
| <p><b>The profanity and repetition in dad’s scolding</b> “you idiot! You always fuck everything up. You always fuck everything!”</p> | Demonstrates | <p>how grief has become displaced aggression. The repetition “you always...” suggests the father is projecting years of anger and resentment onto Harry, and the profanity demonstrates a loss of emotional control and intense rage. Rather than addressing the immediate situation, he blames Harry for everything.</p> |  | <p>Eliciting</p>                          | <p>a profound sense of sympathy towards Harry among the audience, and making them question the ethics of verbal abuse toward a child.</p>                                             |
| <p><b>The short and</b></p>                                                                                                          | Emphasises   | <p>Harry’s resignation after dad’s brutal</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  | <p>This helps the audience to realise</p> | <p>The detrimental emotional impact</p>                                                                                                                                               |

|                                                                                                                                                                         |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |                                  |                                                                                                                                                       |
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| <p>fragmented sentences” Harry just closed his eyes then. He just shut his eyes.</p>                                                                                    |                   | <p>abuse, suggesting he has become powerless in the face of ongoing abuse.</p>                                                                                                                                                       |  |                                  | <p>of abusive relationships-continuous torment will eventually distinguish people’s hope of extricating themselves from it till death frees them.</p> |
| <p>The symbolism of the “white pointer's tooth”</p>                                                                                                                     | <p>symbolises</p> | <p>Not only the father's trauma surrounding his wife's betrayal but also Harry's connection to his mother. When dad recognises it, “It's his,” the suppressed emotions resurface.</p>                                                |  | <p>Revealing to the audience</p> | <p>Simple everyday objects can act as triggers to reignite people’s grief and anger.</p>                                                              |
| <p>Dad’s resentful dialogue with repetition“She was leaving, because of him. Because of you.” in a hysterical tone, responded by Harry’ brief and cold “I am glad”.</p> | <p>Reveals</p>    | <p>The father’s unresolved trauma has led to his fixation on blame and redirecting it to Harry. In response, Harry's brief statement acts as a catalyst. Its brevity creates shock and dramatically escalates the father's rage,</p> |  | <p>This warns the audience</p>   | <p>Unaddressed trauma can distort perceptions and fuel abusive behaviours.</p>                                                                        |

|                                                                                                                                                                     |                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                        |                                                                                                         |
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|                                                                                                                                                                     |                       | forcing the father to confront his deepest wounds, triggering the violent climax.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |                                        |                                                                                                         |
| <p><b>The contrast between Miles' internal fear and calm words</b> in the life-threatening scene, "We just have to wait, Harry. We're OK.", "No sharks, Harry."</p> | Not only demonstrates | <p>Miles' reassurance and protection as an elder brother, but also his maturity and selflessness as Miles reassures Harry despite being frightened himself.</p> <p><b>The repeated use</b> of Harry's name creates a caring, comforting tone, showing Miles acting as a protector, putting Harry's emotional needs before his own fears.</p> |  | Inspiring the audience to realise that | courage is not the absence of fear, but the choice to carry it quietly for the sake of those they love. |
| <p><b>The repetition of</b> "He should have checked. He should have made sure."</p>                                                                                 | Shows                 | Miles blames himself for Harry's suffering, reflecting his deep sense of responsibility and care.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  | Helping the audience understand        | Guilt often stems from a profound sense of love and responsibility.                                     |

|                                                                                                        |            |                                                                                                                                                   |  |                                        |                                                                                                                                                                            |
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| <p><b>The symbolism of “fire” that Miles “tried to imagine”</b> in life-threatening moments,</p>       | symbolises | hope, resilience, and the strength of Miles' love for Harry, suggesting that their brotherly bond gives Miles the determination to keep fighting. |  | Showing the audience that              | When circumstances are at their darkest, the determination to stay alive for our loved ones can sustain hope and help us endure.                                           |
| <p><b>The inclusive language “We'll be all right,”</b></p>                                             | Emphasises | Unity as Miles never focuses solely on himself; he consistently thinks of their survival together, reinforcing the idea of brotherhood.           |  | This helps the readers understand that | Adversity often reveals our interdependence. Rather than focusing solely on personal survival, people frequently draw courage and resilience from their bonds with others. |
| <p><b>The selfless and caring connotation of “share” in “share it with Harry through his skin”</b></p> | suggests   | Miles is trying to give Harry his strength, hope, and warmth.                                                                                     |  | Positioning the audience to understand | Brotherhood can be strengthened through going through hardships together.                                                                                                  |
| Form the analytical sentence:                                                                          |            |                                                                                                                                                   |  |                                        |                                                                                                                                                                            |



# How The Truman Show predicted our digital reality

[FILM](#)[POP CULTURE](#)[RETROSPECTIVE](#)**Anthony Frajman**

Writer

**A quarter of a century later, Australian director Peter Weir's masterpiece has never been more relevant.**

Few films were as prescient as *The Truman Show*. Released in 1998, before technology had completely infiltrated our lives, it foretold the rise of reality TV, mass surveillance, social media, influencer marketing and our increasing obsession with celebrity.

It subverted Hollywood conventions for a blockbuster feature; it was not based on any existing material, nor reliant on extravagant visual effects, and combined aspects of several genres including romantic comedy, psychological drama, sci-fi, metafiction and social satire.

Directed by Peter Weir (*Picnic at Hanging Rock*, *Dead Poets Society*) and written by Andrew Niccol (*Gattaca*, *Lord of War*), *The Truman Show* was set in the fictional town of Seahaven and followed the seemingly idyllic life of an average insurance salesman, Truman Burbank (Jim Carrey), who is yet to realise that every part of his life has been fabricated, and since birth, he has unknowingly been the star of a 24-hour reality TV show watched by 1.5 billion viewers

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Anticipating both the CCTV surveillance which blankets our world today and our current obsession with recording everything on our smartphones, *The Truman Show* follows its subject's every move through 5,000 cameras placed in his orbit – on car wing mirrors, inside a neighbour's garbage bin, on the wedding ring on his finger – controlled by the show's creator Christof (Ed Harris), who manipulates the oblivious Truman into inhabiting his manufactured reality, from his surroundings to his relationships, including his best friend 'Marlon' (Noah Emmerich) and his wife, 'Meryl' (Laura Linney). Christof even engineers the 'death' of Truman's father at sea to infect Truman with thalassophobia – a fear of large bodies of water – to prevent him from leaving the island, only to reunite Truman with his father decades later to create a dramatic narrative for the show.

Years before the complex issues of consent and privacy became major topics (and long before there were corporate data hacks and reports of smart-home devices being used to spy on customers), *The Truman Show* highlighted these ethical quandaries via Christof's exploitative behaviour.



Jim Carrey in *The Truman Show* (1998)

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Ed Harris in *The Truman Show* (1998)

There are also several social developments *The Truman Show* could credibly claim to have warned us about: the 24-hour news cycle, product placement, parasocial relationships, the merging of entertainment and news; Truman has his own, fictional talk-show devoted to discussing the latest developments in his life, *TruTalk*, years before accompanying TV panel shows like *Talking Married* would become the norm.

Yet it wasn't just the film's concerns and predictions which were radical, but the approach of director Peter Weir.

Following the model he had used in *Dead Poets Society* (1989), by casting Robin Williams against type, Weir selected Jim Carrey, fresh from *The Mask* (1994), *Dumb and Dumber* (1994), and the Ace Ventura films (1994–5), for the more subtly comedic role of Truman.

Weir also made several bold creative choices. In building the look of the film, he drew on the work of painter Norman Rockwell to imbue his Seahaven setting with an early-mid twentieth century American aesthetic. Inspired by the perspective of surveillance camera footage, Weir

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It cemented Carrey's reputation as a versatile actor capable of much more than zaniness and physical contortions, and it became another major achievement in Peter Weir's storied career, confirming him as one of Australia's pre-eminent directors.

Yet perhaps its ultimate legacy is its cautionary message on what was to come in the twenty-first century. In the fictional viewers' mindless complicity in Truman's manipulation through simply watching the series, Weir and Niccol forced us to confront our own viewing choices and make aware how easily we are shaped by the things we're exposed to: corporations, advertising, technology, the media, celebrities.

Ultimately, *The Truman Show* is a stern warning to place a watchful eye on our beliefs, the people we trust and the roles we play.

– Anthony Frajman

## Continue to Part 2: an interview with Peter Weir



ARTICLE

**Crafting Reality: Peter Weir on The Truman Show's impact**

How are these works connected?

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## EXAMPLE ESSAY WRITING GUIDE

How does **the form** of your prescribed text contribute to the way **personal and cultural backgrounds** are revealed?

### Part 1: Introduction

- ☐ Thesis
- ☐ Introduce your three texts
- ☐ Leading sentence/introduction of concepts

**Your Idea 1 about the concept in formal language ; Your idea 2 about the concept in formal language.** These notions are thoroughly and expertly explored in **INSERT POEM NAME by INSERT COMPOSER, INSERT POEM NAME by INSERT COMPOSER AND INSERT POEM NAME by INSERT COMPOSER,** thus, shedding light on the **REWORD FIRST CONCEPT** and **REWORD SECOND CONCEPT.**

**Personal and cultural backgrounds both significantly and innately shape who we are; claiming one's identity is a continuous internal negotiation profoundly affected by our heritage and unique personal experiences. These notions are thoroughly and expertly explored in The Double Man by Ouyang Yu, Translucent Jade by Maureen Ten, and Circular Breathing by Jaya Savage, thus shedding light on the significance of personal experiences and heritage in forming identities.**

*Note: Some of these words are better than others to use!*

| WORD BANK                                                                                |                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Powerful<br>Effective<br>Insightful<br>Significant<br>Reveal<br>Highlight<br>Demonstrate | Compelling<br>Thought-provoking<br>Display<br>Emphasise<br>Relate<br>Display<br>Express<br>Communicate |

### Part 2: 2 x Body paragraphs

- ☐ Topic sentence about your first concept
- ☐ Analyse evidence from poem (e.g. the technique+ evidence+ text level analysis+ audience level analysis)
- ☐ Linking sentence

#### TOPIC SENTENCE RELATING TO THE FIRST CONCEPT IN CAUSE AND EFFECT STRUCTURE.

**CONCEPT 1** is skillfully explored by **AUTHOR LAST NAME** in the poem **INSERT NAME OF POEM** through the employment of **INSERT TECHNIQUE**, stating INSERT EVIDENCE, highlighting **ADD YOUR TEXT LEVEL ANALYSIS**. This positions the audience to **ADD YOUR AUDIENCE LEVEL ANALYSIS**. Furthermore, **AUTHOR LAST NAME** adeptly adopts **INSERT TECHNIQUE** in INSERT EVIDENCE expressing **ADD YOUR TEXT LEVEL ANALYSIS**, evoking a sense of **ADD EMOTIONS among the audience** and inviting them to **ADD YOUR AUDIENCE LEVEL ANALYSIS**. Similarly/Likewise/Contrastingly, in **INSERT NAME OF POEM**, **AUTHOR LAST NAME** masterfully captures **CONCEPT 1** through **INSERT TECHNIQUE** in INSERT EVIDENCE, communicating **ADD YOUR TEXT LEVEL ANALYSIS**. This provokes/encourages/urges the readers to **ADD YOUR AUDIENCE LEVEL ANALYSIS**. Therefore, this **INSERT VERB** **REPHRASE TOPIC SENTENCE**.

Personal experiences, especially societies where individuals grew up in, and their cultural heritage both significantly contributed to their identities, thus neglecting either side will incur inner conflicts and lack of sense of belonging. The significance of both one's heritage and one's current social environment is skillfully captured by Yu in TDM through an extensive paradoxical structure. Using metaphor, Yu compares his name to "crystalisation of two cultures" with his "surname is china" and "given name australia", indicating that they both play a crucial role in shaping his identity. This positions the audience to realise the inseparable relation between cultural backgrounds and personal backgrounds in shaping individuals' identity. Furthermore, Yu expresses his lack of sense of belonging through word play of "motherland" and "otherland", insinuating that without fully acknowledging both his heritage and his experience as an immigrant, he feels like an outsider in both countries, evoking a sense of sympathy among the audience and provoking them to think about the inner struggles immigrants encounter in societies where liminality is not well accepted. Contrastingly, With the structure of a stream of consciousness, Savage adeptly displays his full awareness of his identity despite that he is far away from his home country. Savage expresses his deep appreciation of the sound of didgeridoo through high modality in "bolt up the stairs" and "claim the sound of home", expressing his sense of pride and joy when he heard the Aboriginal music and identifying with the culture behind it despite being thousands miles away from home; whereas when he was in his home country, he took it for granted as in "rarely slow to hear". This positions the audience to see our cultural background, together with unique personal experiences, intrinsically working together to help us realise who we are

and where we belong. Therefore, personal and cultural background equally and both significantly shape our identity.

**TOPIC SENTENCE RELATING TO THE SECOND CONCEPT IN CAUSE AND EFFECT STRUCTURE.**  
**CONCEPT 2** is skillfully explored by **AUTHOR LAST NAME** in the poem **INSERT NAME OF POEM** through the employment of **INSERT TECHNIQUE**, stating **INSERT EVIDENCE**, highlighting **ADD YOUR TEXT LEVEL ANALYSIS**. This positions the audience to **ADD YOUR AUDIENCE LEVEL ANALYSIS**. Furthermore, **AUTHOR LAST NAME** adeptly adopts **INSERT TECHNIQUE** in **INSERT EVIDENCE** expressing **ADD YOUR TEXT LEVEL ANALYSIS**, evoking the audience to develop a sense **ADD EMOTIONS** and inviting them to **ADD YOUR AUDIENCE LEVEL ANALYSIS**. Similarly/Likewise/Contrastingly, in **INSERT NAME OF POEM**, **AUTHOR LAST NAME** masterfully captures **CONCEPT 2** through **INSERT TECHNIQUE** in **INSERT EVIDENCE**, communicating **ADD YOUR TEXT LEVEL ANALYSIS**. This provokes/encourages/urges the readers to **ADD YOUR AUDIENCE LEVEL ANALYSIS**. Therefore, this **INSERT VERB** **REPHRASE TOPIC SENTENCE**.

*Note: Some of these words are better than others to use!*

| WORD BANK                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| similarly<br>furthermore<br>also<br>additionally<br>contrastingly<br>However<br>Reveals<br>Foreshadows<br>Highlights<br>Emphasises | In comparison<br>This is supported by<br>Shows<br>Demonstrates<br>Symbolises<br>Shows<br>Juxtaposes<br>Positions the audience to<br>Confuses<br>Disorients | Bilingualism<br>Anaphora<br>Repetition<br>Simile<br>Metaphor<br>Imagery<br>Sensory imagery<br>Rhyme<br>Alliteration<br>Lack of punctuation |

**Part 3: Conclusion**

**Overall, the poems** **INSERT NAME OF POEM**, **INSERT NAME OF POEM** and **INSERT NAME OF POEM** all **INSERT VERB** **INSERT VERB KEY WORD 1 FROM PROMPT** and **KEY WORD 2 FROM PROMPT** through **SUMMARISE TWO CONCEPTS YOU LOOKED AT**.

*Don't forget the rubric:*

Language has the power to both reflect and shape **individual and collective identity**. In this module, students explore and analyse the ways that language is used to express the **complexities and subtleties of personal, social and cultural identity**. They investigate how textual forms and conventions and language structures and features are used to communicate information, **ideas, values and attitudes** which inform and influence **perceptions of ourselves and other peoples**. Students also consider the impact texts have on shaping **individuals' or communities' sense of identity**.

Through the study of one prescribed text and a selection of related material, students develop awareness and understanding of how our perceptions of and relationships with others and the world are shaped by written, spoken and visual language. Through close language study, and by experimenting with different language choices, they consider and reflect on ways that texts **affirm or challenge prevailing assumptions and beliefs about individuals and lifestyles, and about social and cultural groupings**. They consider **representations of and perspectives on culture and identity** and they investigate and reflect on their own and others' experiences of **adapting to changed circumstances**.

Cultural dislocation can be experienced by many migrants, leading to feelings of isolation.

Option 1: This notion is thoroughly explored by Yu and Ten in their respective poems, as they reflect upon the challenges of moving to a new country.

Option 2: Yu effectively explores this concept, utilising the paradoxical structure of TDM to symbolise the duality of his torn identity.

1. "Language is the road map of a culture." To what extent does language define identity in the texts you have studied?
2. In a globalised world, individuals often negotiate multiple identities. How is this process reflected through language in the prescribed texts?
3. Discuss how language can both empower and marginalise individuals, with particular reference to cultural identity in your prescribed texts.
4. "Maintaining a heritage language is essential to preserving one's cultural identity." Evaluate this statement with reference to your prescribed texts.
5. Analyse how the use of language in your prescribed texts challenges or reinforces cultural stereotypes and identities.

**Module C Question: Characterisation is a crucial element of storytelling. Discuss this statement with close reference to your prescribed text.**

**A composer's tool, characterisation, enforces challenging ideas within their stories. Without characterisation, the story cannot be "told" rendering it disjointed. Asserting his post-modern values, Peter Weir's 1998 'The Truman Show' undermines the power the media weaponises over society and is done so through the docile persona of Truman Burbank, living in a world of artifice, since birth. This fabricated world, forces Truman to believe it is his "American Dream," supressing his self-agency and empowering Christof to continue his deceit. Without the characterisation of Truman, Christof and Sylvia, Weir's messages could not have been achieved.**

**Characterisation is a crucial element of underlying ideas. While a naïve Truman strives to understand the falsity of his life, his incarceration slowly dawning on him through a series of studio mishaps, Christof strives to keep Truman ignorant of his situation. Christof is constructed as a pristine figure, he dons a black outfit, beret and spectacles, achieving a sophisticated visage. His mannerisms are poised yet show undertones of callousness, for example, his smirk through dialogue, "Truman is the first child to be legally adopted by a corporation," Christof's status is clear, he is exalted as a "creator of beautiful things." Yet the audience can see the deviant perversity of his nature, especially in contrast to Truman's innocence. The voyeuristic mise-en-scene of Truman's backside positioned in a close up shot negates Truman's right to privacy and Christof's intrusive manner. Although embedded in humour, this cinematography ignites Christof's god-like construct, as he barks directions such as, "Cue the sun." This emphasises his divine ability to control Seahaven entirely. Non-diegetic operatic music elevates Christof's sense of himself as a classical artist, not the manipulative narcissist the audience know him to be. The dramatic irony in his characterisation tells us a story, that the studio heads that pervade our world are ego maniacs who consider themselves artists of the highest order, or even, God. Their power is too great, and they wield it in a cruel and selfish manner.**

Characterisation reinforces the film's commentary on the artificiality of television and advertising. Weir's motive to debate the conscience of the media is evident in the characterisation of Sylvia. She is shaped as Truman's true love, in a rare organic moment he accidentally achieved in the dome of his orchestrated life. Sylvia is also characterised as a "whistle-blower" to the deplorable actions of Christof and acts as a beacon of hope for Truman, both within the studio dome and out in the real world. Sylvia defends Truman on, "Tru-Talk," a talkback show, by calling out the unethical acts Christof has committed against Truman. While Christof seems to be highly praised by the show's host, Sylvia yells, "You're a liar and a cheat and what you've done to Truman is sick!" The handheld camera movement in tandem with the setting of plastered propaganda posters further reveal Weir's purpose. Essentially, Sylvia becomes the voice of the audience and embodies the morality that still exists in the real world. While Weir's storytelling makes villains of corporations and the media, he has no intention of painting all humanity as being bereft of morals. Hence, the characterisation of Sylvia is a vitally important distinction in the story. Without the hope she represents, the film would be too dark.

Trapped in a society who worships the media and disregards the ethical ramifications of Seahaven, an anomaly lives amongst the actors. Truman evolves into a hero and seeks autonomy despite the constant gaslighting he has been subjected to. Truman is initially censored by his own niceties, "Good afternoon, Good evening and Good night," yet morphs into a clever escape artist. He cheekily breaks the fourth wall in his bathroom mirror mid-shot, telling the crew, "That one was for free." This was his alert that he has discovered the truth, he knows his life is a production. The climatic moment of mortal versus God in the storm scene, highlights Christof's villainy and Truman's heroism. The aerial shot of Truman, lying almost dead on the ship's mast is a biblical allusion to Jesus dying on the cross, thereby highlighting Truman's life being sacrificed for others. As Truman is released joyous music ensues and Weir cuts to a slow-motion sequence of Sylvia running to meet Truman.

Without the archetypal yet nuanced characterisation of Truman, Christof and Sylvia, we would not be as emotionally connected to the story or feel as passionate about Weir's agenda to debase corporate corruption and media pervasion. This once naïve and vulnerable protagonist, Truman Burbank, manages, against all odds, to triumph over the domineering and powerful grasp of Christof. Ultimately, Weir paints a grim fable about the media, yet, through his characterisation, a glowing tribute to the power of love and the irrepressibility of the human spirit.





# Contemporary Asian Australian Poets

Edited by  
Adam Aitken,  
Kim Cheng Boey  
& Michelle Cahill



Puncher & Wattmann Poetry

## The Double Man

Ouyang Yu

my name is  
a crystallisation of two cultures  
my surname is china  
my given name australia  
if i translate that direct into english  
my surname becomes australia  
my given name china  
i do not know what motherland means  
i possess two countries  
or else  
i possess neither  
my motherland is my past  
my motherland is my present  
my past motherland is my past  
my present motherland is my present  
when i go to china  
i say i'm returning to my home country  
when i go to australia  
i say i'm returning to my home country  
wherever i go  
it is with a heart tinged in two colours  
although there is han jian in chinese  
there isn't ao jian in english  
i write in chinese  
like australians do in english  
our motherlands have one thing in common:  
they've both lost M  
i have nullified my home  
i have set up a home  
in two hundred years' time  
i shall be the father of the double man

Note: *han jian*: Chinese traitor; *ao jian*: Australian traitor.

## Some New Perspectives

*Ee Tiang Hong*

Race, language, religion, birthplace -  
the categories do not satisfy:  
what do they say of you and me,  
the space, the silences between?

Not always negative, I am  
more or less than your images,  
the truth is always partly,  
a few hints here and there.

That's how it is - conceptual  
smithereens, in spurts  
and starts, a world view,  
the twentieth century's, ours.

## Translucent Jade

Maureen Ten (Ten Ch'in Ü)

My grandfather made me a gift when I was born.  
I used it for a while until another gift, my mother's,  
flashed into view. Common in its place of origin, here  
her gift sparkled and sang, replaced the other.  
Not that his was jostled aside, but it sort of slipped away.  
No one seemed to mind, if they noticed, as it lay in disuse  
and then was quite forgotten.

Today I retrieved his gift from its silence.  
Barely, rarely used, it seemed mostly new.  
Pristine. I tried it on.  
It was a little strange,  
as is from a world I hadn't inhabited but had heard stories about  
Sometimes I felt an imposter  
Sometimes I thought it reflected hidden aspects I could own.

What vibrations are these?  
Does this begin to become me,  
Do I to it belong?  
This translucent, slowly-yielding music  
Chinese name.

## My Hakka Grandmother

*Eileen Chong*

If time could unwind for you  
yet be still for me: we would run  
through the fields, feet unbound  
and pummeling the ground towards

the earth-house. I read about it once:  
its architecture unique to the Hakka people  
in Fujian. Dwellings like wedding rings  
stacked up and interlinked. You would lead me

through the building's single gate  
and show me where you slept, above  
the communal granary. It would smell  
of rice husks, like your dark hair

in the mornings before we'd braid it  
long and sleek. I would speak  
in your tongue, but we would not need  
words. The lines on my palms mirror

yours almost perfectly. I wonder where  
our bloodline begins. We are guest people  
without land or name, moving south and south,  
wild birds seeking a place to call home.

### *For Samuel Wagon Watson*

There's a man with dreadlocks playing the didgeridoo  
in the Piazza di Santa Maria, and everyone is listening.  
Kids sit by the fountain swapping smokes for laughs,  
tourists lick gelati as they pass illicit markets,  
belts, handbags, sunglasses, all made in \_\_\_\_\_  
the place scratched off. Nuns halt, then the Carabinieri,  
white gloves, black steel-capped boots glistening.

The crowd hems the young musician in,  
Faces glazed with wonder: from where could this  
Strange music have come? Surely not this hemisphere.  
A drone as deep as unexcavated ruins, far older  
Even than the Forum: Armani, Ray-Ban, Dolce  
& Gabbana, all sink at once into equivalence.

He doesn't do the kangaroo, the mosquito or  
the speeding Holden. Just one dark warm lush hum,  
the clean energy of circular breathing, lungs  
and instrument the sum, familiar as the accordion  
yet strange, as though not for money, nor just for fun,  
but for reasons unknowable – some vast, unhurried Om.

I want to bolt up the stairs of the fountain  
and claim that sound as the sound of my home -  
but stop when I recall how rarely I slow to hear  
the truer player busking in King George Square.  
Memory kinks my measured walk into a lurch.  
My stomach fills with fire. Far above cold stars wheel  
around the spire of Rome's oldest Christian church.



## THIS IS WHERE IT BEGINS

Merlinda Bobis

*Once upon a time in Bikol, Pilipino, English —  
we tell it over and over again.*

Digde ini nagpopoon. Anum na taon ako, siguro lima.  
Si Lola nag-iistorya manongod sa parahabon nin kasag  
Na nagtatago sa irarom kan kama.

Dito ito nagsisimula. Anim na taon ako, siguro lima.  
Si Lola nagkukuwento tungkol sa magnanakaw ng alimango  
na nagtatago sa ilalim ng kama.

This is where it begins. I am six years old, perhaps five.  
Grandmother is storytelling about the crab-stealer  
hiding under the bed. Each story-word crackles  
under the ghost's teeth, infernal under my skin. I shiver.

But perhaps this is where it begins.  
Grandfather teasing me with that lady in the hills  
walking into his dream, each time a different  
colour of dress, a different attitude under my skin.  
I am bereft of constancy, literal  
at six years old, perhaps five.

Or, this is where it begins.  
Mother reviewing for her college Spanish exam:  
'Ojos.'  
'Labios.'  
'Manos.'  
Suddenly also under my skin, long before I understood  
'Eyes': how they conjure ghosts under the bed,  
'Lips': how they make ghosts speak,  
'Hands': how they cannot be silent.

I remember too Father gesturing, invoking  
once upon a time. This is where it begins.  
Story, word, gesture  
all under my skin. At six years old, perhaps five.

And so this poem is for my father, mother,  
grandmother, grandfather and all the storytellers,  
the conjurers who came before us. They made us shiver  
not just over crab-stealers hiding under the bed  
or a lady uncertain of her garb. They made us shiver  
also over faith, over tenderness.

Or that little tickle when a word hits a hidden  
crevice in the ear. Just air  
heralding the world or worlds that we think  
we dream up alone.

No, storytelling is not lonely,  
not as we claim—in our little rooms lit only  
by a lamp or a late computer glow.  
Between the hand and the pen, or the eye and the screen,  
they have never left, they who ‘storytold’ before us,  
they who are under our skin.

Perhaps they even conjured us, but not alone.  
Storytelling, all our eyes collect into singular seeing,  
our lips test one note over and over again,  
our hands follow each other’s arc, each sweep of resolve.  
Eyes, lips, hands conjoined: the umbilical cord restored.

**“Literature reveals individuals engaging with their environment.” Discuss this statement with close reference to your prescribed text.**

Films have the unique ability to profoundly expand our appreciation of individuals engaging with their environment. Peter Weir’s 1998 satirical film, “The Truman Show,” has distinctive qualities that convey ideas about one’s perception of reality, media, and individual autonomy. Weir’s construction of scenes and use of cinematic techniques portray settings and situations of contemporary society that reciprocate ideas of environmental entrapment, creating a cautionary tale. Through his masterful characterisation of Truman Burbank, Weir extends his audience’s appreciation of how individuals interact with their environments and their perception of reality. Hence, Weir communicates the susceptibility of individuals to their surrounding environment, expanding his audience’s self-awareness and prompting them to question their own reality.

Great filmmakers truthfully portray people to broaden our understanding of the fragility of reality. Weir’s creation of Truman as blissful and well-mannered allows his character to represent the kind-hearted every man living a normal, modern-day life. Truman’s **comical dialogue** to his fellow neighbours, “Good morning, and in case I don’t see ya, good afternoon, good evening and goodnight” conveys his level of belonging within his environment. The employment of **colloquial terms** such as ‘ya’ instead of ‘you’ represent Truman’s laid-back, personable nature that may resonate with the audience. Additionally, Truman undergoes everyday chores and habits, as seen in the extreme long-shot of him mowing the lawn, which emphasises his acceptance of the artificial environment he inhabits and **symbolises** his lack of power. Through Weir’s portrayal of Truman being a standard citizen, he can effectively hint to the audience that Truman is in fact resembling all humans of our contemporary society. Essentially, Weir expands his audience’s appreciation of how individuals engage with their environment through revealing one’s ignorance of reality and by making Truman a relatable symbol of every human.

The notion of the subjectivity of reality is explored cynically by Weir. The close-up shot of Christof's face emitting the imperative, "we accept the reality of the world with which we are presented. It's as simple as that." Through this use of language, Weir powerfully reveals that Truman's acceptance of his world is how any other humans in modern-day society would accept theirs. This expands his audience's appreciation further through promoting the viewer to reflect upon their own engagement with the world around them, and question how real their world really is. Thus, Weir's use of cinematic techniques to portray his characters, enables him to reflect on the manner that humans in contemporary society succumb to their environment, expanding his audience's understanding of their vulnerability to conformity and ignorance. "The Truman Show," satirises modern society, portraying dystopian ideas that we are imprisoned by media and advertisement, expanding the audience's awareness of their stance in the world. Truman's world initially appears as a utopia, emphasised by Seahaven's smiling citizens, the town's pastel colour palette and the use of the diegetic music of Mozart, a composer known for his perfect use of balance. However, this world shifts from utopian to dystopian as the audience realise that Truman is trapped in an artificial environment created entirely for the economic gain of its producers. The recurring motif of product placement in several scenes in the film contributes to the monetised reality that the producers have created. For instance, as Truman is walking to work, two men pin him against a poster and a zoom-in shot reveals it is for "Kaiser's Free-Range Chicken", facing the audience, Truman has his back forcibly shoved into the advertising billboard to gain the perfect shot of the product. The use of a zoom-in technique conveys the idea that the audience are the ones being manipulated by mass media and consumerism, more than Truman himself. This prompts the audience to question their individual autonomy, and the extent to which an individual controls how they interact with their environment in modern day society, alluding to the dominance of advertising and media. The audience is confronted with the fearful notion that we are possibly as entrapped as Truman.

Curiosity is an omnipotent aspect of humanity that enables people to transcend their limits. Weir suggests to the audience that individuals are often controlled by the dominance of media and surveillance. The imprisonment experienced by Truman is symbolised by the fishbowl cameras, which occurs when we see Truman through the buttonholes of other actors. The fishbowl represents how an individual may not realise how limited their environment is, just as a fish does not know anything exists beyond its bowl. However, Weir's choice to allow Truman to escape Seahaven despite his severe entrapment, ultimately conveys how one's curiosity for truth about the world is unbreakable. This is alluded to by the dialogue "you never had a camera inside my head," which conveys how although one physically succumbs to their environment, the physiological need for exploration is inextricable. Thus, through enabling Truman to escape Seahaven, Weir builds his audience's appreciation of the strength of curiosity and pays tribute to our deep-seeded need to explore our natural habitats, both our home and beyond.

Ultimately, Peter Weir expands his audience's appreciation of the individuals engaging with their environment. He achieves this through demonstrating the susceptibility of individuals to their environment and highlighting the fragility of reality. However, he also challenges the prevailing assumption of humanity's vulnerability, through demonstrating the sheer power of curiosity and spirit.

# Camera Techniques

## 1. Close-up (CU)

Shows a character's face in detail.

**Impact:** Creates emotional intimacy, lets the audience read subtle expressions, builds empathy.

## 2. Long shot / Wide shot

Shows the full body or environment.

**Impact:** Establishes setting, can make characters seem isolated or insignificant.

## 3. High angle shot

Camera looks down on subject.

**Impact:** Makes the subject appear weak, vulnerable, or powerless.

## 4. Low angle shot

Camera looks up at subject.

**Impact:** Suggests power, dominance, or intimidation.

## 5. Tracking / Dolly shot

Camera moves alongside the subject.

**Impact:** Creates immersion and keeps the audience engaged in the action.

# Editing Techniques

## 1. Montage

A sequence of shots compressed in time.

**Impact:** Shows development quickly (e.g., training, passage of time), builds emotional intensity.

## 2. Cross-cutting (parallel editing)

Cuts between two scenes happening simultaneously.

**Impact:** Builds tension and suspense, connects storylines.

## 3. Jump cut

Abrupt transition between shots.

**Impact:** Creates disorientation, highlights chaos or urgency.

## 4. Shot-reverse-shot

Back-and-forth between characters (often in dialogue).

**Impact:** Engages the audience in relationships and conflict.

# Lighting

## 1. High-key lighting

Bright, even lighting with few shadows.

**Impact:** Creates a positive, open, or safe mood (common in comedies).

## 2. Low-key lighting

Strong contrast, deep shadows.

**Impact:** Builds tension, mystery, or fear (common in thrillers/horror).

## 3. Backlighting

Light from behind the subject.

**Impact:** Creates silhouettes, can make characters seem mysterious or symbolic.

# Mise-en-scène (Everything in the frame)

## 1. Costume & makeup

**Impact:** Reveals character personality, status, or transformation.

## 2. Props

**Impact:** Can symbolise themes or foreshadow events.

## 3. Setting

**Impact:** Establishes context, influences mood and meaning.

## 4. Colour

- Warm colours → comfort, passion
- Cool colours → sadness, isolation

**Impact:** Subtly influences emotional response.

# Sound

## 1. Diegetic sound (within the film world)

**Impact:** Creates realism and immersion.

## 2. Non-diegetic sound (e.g., soundtrack, voice-over)

**Impact:** Guides audience emotions and interpretation.

## 3. Silence

**Impact:** Builds tension, draws attention to key moments.

# **Performance & Dialogue**

## **1. Acting (facial expressions, body language)**

**Impact:** Shapes how audiences interpret characters and emotions.

## **2. Dialogue**

**Impact:** Reveals themes, relationships, and character motivations.

## YEAR 12 ENGLISH EAL/D – ESSAY SUMMARY SHEET

**Module:** Texts and Human Experiences

**Text(s) Studied:** *Past the Shallows* by Favel Parrett

### KEY CONCEPTS

*You can use these/adapt them for conceptual topic sentences.*

- Dependence on the environment can lead to unhealthy connections and co-dependence.
- Subversion in family roles can cause young people to mature quickly, taking on board complex responsibilities.
- Physical isolation can lead to emotional isolation, particularly within small communities.
- Emotional isolation can be damaging for individuals, particularly when it is experienced within a family, causing humans to question their relationships. (The link between physical environments and emotions)
- Community can strengthen individuals, however, lack of community leads to... (the power of community and relationships)
- The human experience of grief often leads to...
- Past trauma can impact... (impact of grief and trauma)
- Memories have the potential to provide human beings with comfort, however, they can also cause...
- Memories associated with grief cause the grieving process to... (How memories can comfort but can cause pain)
- Trauma building resilience, leading individuals to...
- Grief and loss, whilst a challenging experience, can cultivate...

### MUST-KNOW EVIDENCE

*You should know more than this...but if you get stuck, these are a few flexible options!*

- The epigraph - it frames the text and then can be related back to other concepts/evidence later on.
- The way Parrett writes about the environment and landscape; scenes where the landscape is being written about in detail are usually symbolic of the characters and what they are going through.
- Dialogue between characters; focus on the different tones between the the brothers
- Flashbacks of the past and how the characters used to be.

### SAMPLE PARAGRAPH

*This is a student example from 2025.*

Trauma distorts feelings, forcing children to bear burdens ~~years~~ beyond their years when adult care fails. The symbolic ~~line~~ line, "Harry knew the water. He could feel it. And knew not

to touch it" aligns with the ocean with the unpredictability of his home life, positioning nature as the metaphor for the hostile emotional landscape he must navigate. The image of cold, threatening water reflects the instability and fear that Miles experiences, mirroring the burden of responsibility unfairly placed on him. This reinforces readers how trauma affects an individual by making responsibility becomes a survival mechanism, not a choice. Similarly, Parret deepens this emotional complexity through the contrast between Miles' initial fear of George Fuller, "kids at school were scared of George Fuller... His face was all squashed in pain and he looked at like a monster master", and George's surprising tenderness when he ~~took~~ "touched [Miles'] forehead lightly" and "gently dabbed at the cut". The juxtaposition between perceived threat and unexpected care complicates Miles' feelings worldview. This invites readers how trauma not only isolates but also reshapes one's understanding of human connection. Through these layered portrayals of trauma and responsibility, Parret ~~breaks~~

our understanding of what it demonstrates. ~~The relationship between~~ means people's feelings and their actions to be human, illustrating how children burdened by parents' failure must navigate a world of emotional contradiction, reinforcing the relationship between people's feelings and their actions that is forced upon the vulnerable.

### Sample questions

Note, these have not been previous HSC questions - they are new ones to practise with.

1. "Experiences of isolation can shape an individual's understanding of themselves and others."

To what extent does *Past the Shallows* explore this idea?

2. "The things left unsaid often have the greatest impact on people's lives."

To what extent does *Past the Shallows* explore the consequences of silence?

3. "Great texts deepen our understanding of people whose experiences differ from our own."

Evaluate how *Past the Shallows* encourages readers to develop empathy.

4. "A text's enduring value lies in its ability to reveal universal truths about human experience."

To what extent does this statement apply to *Past the Shallows*?